

Alma 8-12

June 17-23

Alma 8 Don't Give Up!

v1 Go home

v5 Reach out

v10 Mighty prayer

v13 Just know

v15 Heaven's
encouragement

v18 Get back to it

v20 Look for God's sends

v22 Eat; be filled

v27 Have a nap

v32 There is Spirit and power
coming

Alma 9 Questions

v2 Q: Who are you?

- Who are you to tell me how to live my life?
- Who are you to tell me that I'm doing something wrong?
- Who are you that you say I need to change the way I think?
- Why should we believe your words?

Who am I to them?

Who are you? Tell me about yourselves.

v6 Q: Who is God?

- Who is this God that sendeth no more authority than one man among this people?
- Who is this God who declares the truth of such great and marvelous things?
- Why should I live my life differently for Him if He is a stranger?
- And why should I listen you if you're one?

v9 He does not respond with "Let me introduce God to you", but is instead "Do you not remember?"

v10 And have you forgotten so soon...?

Alma 9 Remember

What's so fascinating is the response

- not why don't you know God not let me introduce and tell you every single thing that I could think about who God is
- let me jolt your memory
- let me remind you that God might not be as stranger to you as you think he is
 - v20 - you have been such a highly favored people of the Lord
 - you have been favored above so many other things
 - v21 - you've been visited by the spirit of God and you've conversed with angels
 - you've been spoken to by the voice of the Lord
 - you've received Revelation
 - you've had prophecy
 - you've had gifts the gift of tongues the gift of preaching
 - v22 - you've been delivered Time and Time Again by the very hand of God
 - you've been saved by Him
 - you've been protected by Him
 - you have been kept and preserved by Him
 - v23 - you have received so many great Blessings by God
- and you might know him better than you think you did you just might not have recognized that it has been God the whole time
- when we feel like God is such a stranger, maybe we just need to take a second and look at our story
- and see if maybe there are moments that God has been closer than we thought
- that maybe he has showed up in a relationship with us in ways that we didn't originally see
- and we just need a reminder that God has been there
- that we know him better than we think we do

Alma 10:1-15 - I would not know.

Amulek begins to teach and he tells his story and he says: Let me introduce myself -

- v4 - I've got no small reputation I've got a lot of money a lot of friends here like you I know the industry
- but let me tell you about this spiritual side of me that you might not know
- v5 - he says even after all the success I've had, I haven't known much of the ways of the Lord before
- his Mysteries or His Marvelous power
- I said I've never known much of these things, but I'm kind of mistaken
- for for I've seen so much of his Mysteries and His Marvelous power and the preservation of the lives of this people
 - I'm learning in the exact same way you are that I might not have realized the whole entire time, but when I look back I realize that I know God better than I thought I did
 - listen I hardened my heart looking back I know that's what I was doing because I was called many times and I would not hear
- v6 - therefore I knew concerning these things yet I would not know
 - and now looking back reflecting on that being honest with myself I realized God did call many times
- I knew he was calling but I just didn't want to know
- I was called many times and I wouldn't go
- I was going on rebelling against God
- In the wickedness of my heart
 - until the fourth day of the seventh month - Fourth of July!!
 - I love that he remembers the day - the very day - that was a day worth remembering

There comes a day...

“To each there comes in their lifetime a special moment when they are figuratively tapped on the shoulder and offered the chance to do a very special thing, unique to them and fitted to their talents. What a tragedy if that moment finds them unprepared or unqualified for that which could have been their finest hour.”

— Sir Winston Churchill

v8 - And it came to pass that I obeyed

- and that was the Turning Point - the tap came on the shoulder from heaven
- and he decided right then and there I'm going to obey
- being ready to obey whatever it may be
- he does and everything changes

Alma 10:16-32 - Were it not

- v22 - Yea, and I say unto you that if it were not for the prayers of the righteous, who are now in the land, that you would even now be visited with utter destruction
 - and he says and it's not going to be a flood - like in Noah's days
 - but it would be by famine, and by pestilence, and by the sword
- He's going to go into specifics and saying - listen you would not be here if it were not for the people who are praying for you
- you would not be here without the prayers of the righteous
- and he repeats it again
- v23 but it is by the prayers of the righteous that you are spared
- Alma 8 - Alma is praying so hard for the people
 - - and you would think that the answer would be like:
 - and so it worked and all the people loved him and it's going to be perfect,
- v11 nevertheless, they hardened their hearts
- Alma probably thought his prayers were failing
- Alma probably thought his prayers were not being answered
 - that things were falling apart - and getting harder - and messier - and it was a big disaster
- but in all reality just two chapters later you get the answer that maybe his prayer was being answered in a way that Alma never expected or thought
- he couldn't see the fruits of his prayer - or the immediate blessings of his the prayer
 - or maybe the prayer didn't get answered in the way that he was hoping that it would
- there's a lesson in realizing that your prayers might be more powerful than you thought
- even the prayers that you didn't think were getting answered God is saving people with
- your prayers are way more significant than you could ever imagine
- The Simplicity of prayer leads you to believe that it wouldn't have the kind of impact that it does
- And sometimes the Simplicity becomes a stumbling block